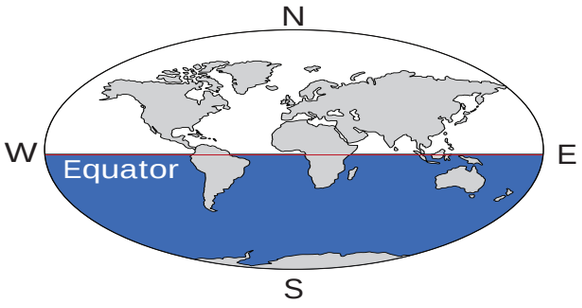
The area of the Earth found between the Equator (0^0) and the North Pole (90°N) is called the **Northern Hemisphere**.

Southern Hemisphere



The area of the Earth from the equator (0°) to the South Pole (90°S) is called the **Southern Hemisphere**.

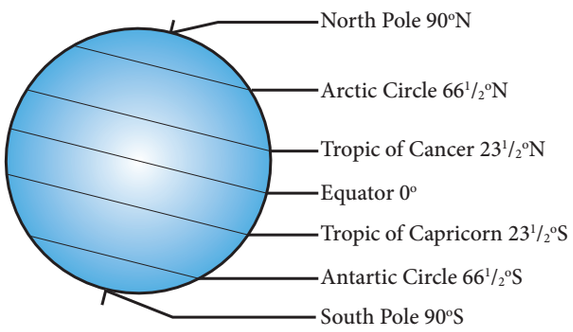
The location of any country or place is based on this division of the hemispheres.

HOTS

Based on the latitudinal extent, in which hemisphere is India located?

Important lines of latitude

The earth rotates on its axis at an inclination of 23½°. It also revolves around the sun while rotating. Based on the angle at which the sun's rays fall on the earth, certain lines of latitude gain significance.

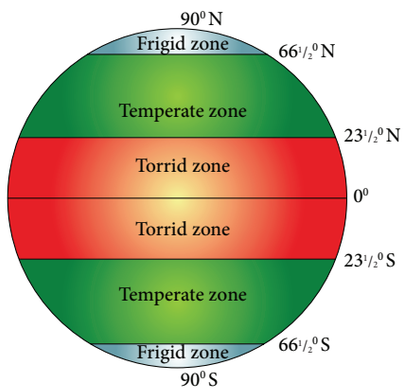


DO YOU KNOW?

- 0°**N** and **S** – 23½°**N** and **S** lines of latitudes are called – **Low latitudes**
- 23½°**N** and **S** – 66½°**N** and **S** lines of latitudes are called – **Middle Latitudes**
- 66½°**N** and **S** – 90°**N** and **S** lines of latitudes are called – **High Latitudes**

(Source : A Dictionary of Geography – Susan Mayhew, Oxford University Press, Fifth edition -2015)

The Sun's rays do not fall equally on all parts of the earth. They fall vertically over the Equator and slanting towards the poles. Thus, all the places on earth do not have the same amount of temperature. Based on the amount of heat received from the Sun, the lines of latitude help in dividing the earth into different climatic zones.



Torrid Zone

The region from the Equator towards the Tropic of Cancer (23½°N) and the Tropic of Capricorn (23½°S) is called the Torrid Zone. The Sun's rays fall vertically over this region and the average temperature is very high. Hence this region is known as the **Torrid Zone.**